

Basics • Chapter 7

Secrets of the scene

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 8 minutes to read

The real secrets of 2DFD are mostly structure. A few people pay, attention is scarce, reach is partly luck, and ideas are copied within weeks.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- Most of the scene's money comes from very few people, and those people come and go.
- Warmth is part of a business that needs retention. It can be sincere and still steer your spending.
- Hours of work do not buy reach, and no rule for staying visible has been checked.
- Many drawn personas are said to be run by someone other than the character, often a man. Nobody has counted.

- A serious dom shows her frame before she asks for money, and never needs a workaround.

You will learn

- Why income rests on a handful of people, and why subs leave.
- What decides who is seen, and which rules are only folklore.
- How to read a persona's claims about who she is.
- Which designs and pressure tactics to recognise and refuse.
- What a serious dom shows before she asks for anything.

I will tell you what the scene keeps quiet, and it is less glamorous than the rumours. Most of it is structure: who pays, who is seen, who copies whom. Read it before you start, as a sub or as a dom, and you will know where the ground is soft.

— Vivian

Money lives in a few hands

In my experience, a persona's income rests on very few people. One supporter can carry a third of a good week or more, and a long follower list can hold only a handful of people who reliably send. A new persona's followers are often other doms who chat but do not spend.

A leaderboard shows this and also hides it. One sub with two accounts can hold two of the top places, and a board that ranks by the number of gifts puts a flood

of tiny sends above a larger earner. A public tally of wins is advertising and proves nothing.

Subs come and go. They leave for a rival, from boredom, curiosity or regret over choices made while aroused. They send every few days or in waves, not daily, and many pay several doms at once. Some vanish after a large send or a relapse, and some return months later. A dom cannot stop anyone leaving, only make staying more appealing.

Read this as a sub. A business that lives on a few people has every reason to keep each of them close. The warmth can still be sincere. The test is whether the performance is steering your spending, and in my experience the person who pays most is the one under the most pressure.

Vivian's field notes

When a dom calls you her favourite, ask what a favourite is worth to her this month. I ask the same of myself whenever I write a kind line.

Reach is a lottery

Who posts matters more than what is posted. A post is shown to a few people and shown further if they react. A weaker post from a favoured account can outperform a better one from an unfavoured one. A repost from a bigger account can lift a small one briefly. Early views say little: a post can idle then rise.

Hours of editing do not buy reach. A plain picture with one word sometimes flies, and a long edit sometimes sits at a few views. A brand-new account is often pushed hard at first, and an older one with poor visibility is treated as dead. An account labelled or hidden from suggestions with an SSB loses most of its reach.

◑ I give no steps: rules differ by platform, and an account made to get round a restriction may be closed. Unverified

---

Myth

A good post that gets few views was a bad post.

Fact

Views follow the account's standing and plain luck at least as much as the post. ◑

Myth

Reach is only luck.

Fact

Getting subs takes work. Landing one large payer rather than a small one is partly luck. ◑

Myth

There are known rules that keep an account clear of the adult label.

Fact

The rules passed around are scene folklore, experienced creators dispute them, and none was checked against the platform's own help pages. Read those pages yourself. Unverified

What wins, and who is behind it

Simple and new tends to beat polished. The tools that do best are often a simple idea nobody bothered to build. A recognisable character and easy setup count as much as the art. Ideas are copied within weeks, and since AI writes most of the code, nothing technical stops a copy. What a copy cannot take is the audience of the account that promotes the tool. Copying a mechanic is common, and the scene dislikes copies without credit. Harming a creator because you dislike her business is no justification.

A drawn persona scales in a way a photographed one cannot, because pictures, voice lines and lore can be made in bulk. A fixed visual recipe makes her readable at thumbnail size.

Many drawn personas are run by someone other than the character, often a man. It is commonly said and nobody has counted it. Some personas that look like a team are one person using AI tools. Unverified Press describes scammers who post stolen photos of attractive women in classic findom. Reported The same trick can work with stolen or generated art. Unverified

The one academic survey of findommes cited in this wiki had 56 respondents, and most identified as women. Verified No study of who runs 2DFD personas could be found for this wiki as of 2026-11-03. Unverified

Myth

The woman in the pictures is the one who answers.

Fact

The character is a role, and who runs it is unknown.

Myth

A beautiful persona proves a real operator.

Fact

Beauty proves nothing, because art can be stolen or generated.

Attention, burnout and the first send

Attention is the scarce resource. A dom's day is split between incoming messages, posting, the community and outside duties. Chatting without sending can still use up a dom's day. Press accounts note that some submissives mainly want to talk to women. Reported Findommes in the academic survey reported verbal abuse and unsolicited sexual images from clients, and named secrecy among the most negative parts of the work. Verified Burnout is the common way out. Pausing is legitimate, and comparing yourself with faster doms only makes it worse.

Protect your attention

1. Set a daily cap on time for contacts who do not send, before the day starts. ◑
2. Tell free chatters that you are busy, and do not undersell your time.
3. Show your frame first: limits, prices and a way to stop.
4. When stress takes over, pause and say so. A pause needs no drama.

How a persona lets people in matters as much, and each way has a cost for you. A small fixed entry send is easy to pay and easy to walk away from, while conditions such as one or two sessions ask more of you before you know her. ◑ Some legitimate dommes ask for payment up front, partly against time-wasters and fakes. ◎ Reported A 2017 press feature describes a drive-by as a one-off client who pays a minimum tribute. ◎ Reported

Some doms ask for a session or two after a first send. Decide beforehand whether you accept that, and how many. A hidden price makes you start a conversation before you know the cost. ◑ Ask for the full cost in writing before any send.

Pressure you may meet

Some designs look like fun. Slot games with deliberate near-misses, bets that rise as the effects grow and bets with no prize for winning are standard devices. Gacha mechanics are copied from commercial games, with rarity stars, pity counters, banners and farming loops. The dom who builds them knows what they do. ◑ Numbers shows the arithmetic.

Red flags

Designs that look like fun

- The reel stops one step short of the prize, again and again.
- A bet has no prize at all for winning.
- A tool copies a pity counter and banners from a commercial game.
- A lock can be removed only by buying something.

Counter. Close it and say stop. Do the sum in Numbers before you send anything. A free stop that always works is the minimum.

The same toolkit holds pressure tactics that some call method. At the hard end, press reports include lines that press a man to sell his car or house as proof of love. Reported Reports also describe blackmail and targeting of people in support groups. Reported

Tactics, and how to refuse them

What they say or do

1 You are special, I care about all my subs, you do not have to send

The counter

Judge a dom by what she asks and rewards in practice. If everyone sends, the reassurance is decoration.

What they say or do

2 I could make you send a fortune with one word, and I will not, because I care

The counter

The power exists whether or not it is used. Trust built this way is dependence.

What they say or do

3 The doms you paid before are losers

The counter

Rate a dom by how she treats you, not by how she rates others.

What they say or do

4 Praise, titles and new projects for work you do for free

The counter

Agree the scope in advance, and keep the right to say no without losing your place.

What they say or do

5 A short firm command, a finished example that makes it look easy, then the same command again when you hesitate

The counter

Hesitation is information. Take the night, and decide in your own time.

What they say or do

6 Hand over your public account so it can show your sends

The counter

Never. It is your identity, not a game feature.

These lines sit in the scene's toolkit. They are listed so that you can see them coming.

Scene politics reach subs. Feuds spill into subs' accounts, and a call-out can be sabotage by proxy. A rumour can spread private screenshots to dozens of people before anyone checks. Supporter names can be seen on public wishlists, and friend doms look at each other's pages. Assume that the name you use is recognised across the scene. ◑

A screenshot reaches you

A screenshot circulates that seems to show a dom admitting she is secretly a sub.

A Post it, because others should know

Not this one. A screenshot is easy to forge, and a rumour like this can cost a dom her subs before anyone checks. ◑

B Do not pass it on, and ask her directly if you know her

The right answer. Reputation travels by hearsay, and a forwarded screenshot is a common smear tool. ◑

C Wait until more people repeat it

Not this one. Repetition is not evidence. Hearsay grows by being repeated. ◑

What a serious dom shows

A serious dom shows her frame before asking for money: limits, what she throws out, the plain truth about prices and a visible way to stop. She tells a sub ahead of time when he must not send, and what follows. She forwards misdirected money at once and says so. She checks availability before she promises a gift. A dom who hides these has told you what she is.

Whatever a sub says about his money, a serious dom does not use it to ask for more. I have heard the argument that most subs who say they are broke are lying. The cost of being wrong falls on him.

Some makers hide what a payment page is. I do not describe how any of it is built. A processor that catches this can freeze the funds, including a sub's money. Unverified Your bank saying no is an answer. A real dom never needs a workaround.

If any of this sounds familiar, set a cap in a calm hour, keep a stop that works at once, and wait before you raise either. If sending already feels hard to stop, read The spiral and Where to get help.

Check yourself

Question 1 of 2

A dom's follower list is long. What does it tell you about her income?

- ◯ That many people pay her
- ◯ Very little, because followers can be other doms or people who never send
- ◯ That she can refund you

Answer. Very little, because followers can be other doms or people who never send. Income rests on a handful of people, and a long list can hide how few they are.

Question 2 of 2

A dom says she could make you send a fortune with one word, and that she will not because she cares. What do you do?

- ◯ Trust her more
- ◯ Notice that the power is there whether or not she uses it
- ◯ Send a little to thank her

Answer. Notice that the power is there whether or not she uses it. Power followed by visible restraint builds trust and dependence together.

Remember it

1. Few people pay most of the money, and they come and go.
2. Warmth can be sincere and still steer your spending.
3. Hours of work do not buy reach, and no rule for staying visible has been checked.
4. The person behind a persona is commonly said to differ from the character, and nobody has counted.
5. Judge a dom by her frame, her asks and her rewards. Your bank saying no is an answer.

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.

Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.
Unverified	Plausible, not proven yet.

1 In my experience, a persona's income rests on very few people.

Vivian's field notes

2 One supporter can carry a third of a good week or more, and a long follower list can hold only a handful of people who reliably send.

Vivian's field notes

3 A new persona's followers are often other doms who chat but do not spend.

Vivian's field notes

4 One sub with two accounts can hold two of the top places, and a board that ranks by the number of gifts puts a flood of tiny sends above a larger earner.

Vivian's field notes

5 A public tally of wins is advertising and proves nothing.

Vivian's field notes

6 They leave for a rival, from boredom, curiosity or regret over choices made while aroused.

Vivian's field notes

7 They send every few days or in waves, not daily, and many pay several doms at once.

Vivian's field notes

8 Some vanish after a large send or a relapse, and some return months later.

Vivian's field notes

9 A dom cannot stop anyone leaving, only make staying more appealing.

Vivian's field notes

10 A business that lives on a few people has every reason to keep each of them close.

Vivian's field notes

11 The test is whether the performance is steering your spending, and in my experience the person who pays most is the one under the most pressure.

Vivian's field notes

12 When a dom calls you her favourite, ask what a favourite is worth to her this month. I ask the same of myself whenever I write a kind line.

Vivian's field notes

13 Who posts matters more than what is posted.

Vivian's field notes

14 A post is shown to a few people and shown further if they react.

Vivian's field notes

15 A weaker post from a favoured account can outperform a better one from an unfavoured one.

Vivian's field notes

16 A repost from a bigger account can lift a small one briefly.

Vivian's field notes

17 Early views say little: a post can idle then rise.

Vivian's field notes

18 A plain picture with one word sometimes flies, and a long edit sometimes sits at a few views.

Vivian's field notes

19 A brand-new account is often pushed hard at first, and an older one with poor visibility is treated as dead.

Vivian's field notes

20 An account labelled or hidden from suggestions with an SSB loses most of its reach.

Vivian's field notes

21 I give no steps: rules differ by platform, and an account made to get round a restriction may be closed.

Unverified

22 Views follow the account's standing and plain luck at least as much as the post.

Vivian's field notes

23 Landing one large payer rather than a small one is partly luck.

Vivian's field notes

24 Read those pages yourself.

Unverified

25 Simple and new tends to beat polished.

Vivian's field notes

26 The tools that do best are often a simple idea nobody bothered to build.

Vivian's field notes

27 A recognisable character and easy setup count as much as the art.

Vivian's field notes

28 Ideas are copied within weeks, and since AI writes most of the code, nothing technical stops a copy.

Vivian's field notes

29 What a copy cannot take is the audience of the account that promotes the tool.

Vivian's field notes

30 Copying a mechanic is common, and the scene dislikes copies without credit.

Vivian's field notes

31 A drawn persona scales in a way a photographed one cannot, because pictures, voice lines and lore can be made in bulk.

Vivian's field notes

32 A fixed visual recipe makes her readable at thumbnail size.

Vivian's field notes

33 Many drawn personas are run by someone other than the character, often a man.

Vivian's field notes

34 Some personas that look like a team are one person using AI tools.

Unverified

35 Press describes scammers who post stolen photos of attractive women in classic findom.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

36 The same trick can work with stolen or generated art.

Unverified

37 The one academic survey of findommes cited in this wiki had 56 respondents, and most identified as women.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

38 No study of who runs 2DFD personas could be found for this wiki as of 2026-11-03.

Unverified

39 The character is a role, and who runs it is unknown.

Vivian's field notes

40 Beauty proves nothing, because art can be stolen or generated.

Vivian's field notes

41 A dom's day is split between incoming messages, posting, the community and outside duties.

Vivian's field notes

42 Chatting without sending can still use up a dom's day.

Vivian's field notes

43 Press accounts note that some submissives mainly want to talk to women.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

44 Findommes in the academic survey reported verbal abuse and unsolicited sexual images from clients, and named secrecy among the most negative parts of the work.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

45 Burnout is the common way out.

Vivian's field notes

46 Pausing is legitimate, and comparing yourself with faster doms only makes it worse.

Vivian's field notes

47 Set a daily cap on time for contacts who do not send, before the day starts.

Vivian's field notes

48 How a persona lets people in matters as much, and each way has a cost for you.

Vivian's field notes

49 A small fixed entry send is easy to pay and easy to walk away from, while conditions such as one or two sessions ask more of you before you know her.

Vivian's field notes

50 Some legitimate dommes ask for payment up front, partly against time-wasters and fakes.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

51 A 2017 press feature describes a drive-by as a one-off client who pays a minimum tribute.

Reported

Three Financial Dominatrixes on How Their Clients Get Off From Simply Handing Over Cash (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260617102438/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Accessed 3 November 2026

52 Some doms ask for a session or two after a first send.

Vivian's field notes

53 A hidden price makes you start a conversation before you know the cost.

Vivian's field notes

54 Slot games with deliberate near-misses, bets that rise as the effects grow and bets with no prize for winning are standard devices.

Vivian's field notes

55 Gacha mechanics are copied from commercial games, with rarity stars, pity counters, banners and farming loops.

Vivian's field notes

56 The dom who builds them knows what they do.

Vivian's field notes

57 The same toolkit holds pressure tactics that some call method.

Vivian's field notes

58 At the hard end, press reports include lines that press a man to sell his car or house as proof of love.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

59 Reports also describe blackmail and targeting of people in support groups.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

60 Feuds spill into subs' accounts, and a call-out can be sabotage by proxy.

Vivian's field notes

61 A rumour can spread private screenshots to dozens of people before anyone checks.

Vivian's field notes

62 Supporter names can be seen on public wishlists, and friend doms look at each other's pages.

Vivian's field notes

63 Assume that the name you use is recognised across the scene.

Vivian's field notes

64 A screenshot is easy to forge, and a rumour like this can cost a dom her subs before anyone checks.

Vivian's field notes

65 Reputation travels by hearsay, and a forwarded screenshot is a common smear tool.

Vivian's field notes

66 Hearsay grows by being repeated.

Vivian's field notes

67 A serious dom shows her frame before asking for money: limits, what she throws out, the plain truth about prices and a visible way to stop.

Vivian's field notes

68 She tells a sub ahead of time when he must not send, and what follows.

Vivian's field notes

69 She forwards misdirected money at once and says so.

Vivian's field notes

70 She checks availability before she promises a gift.

Vivian's field notes

71 A dom who hides these has told you what she is.

Vivian's field notes

72 The cost of being wrong falls on him.

Vivian's field notes

73 Some makers hide what a payment page is.

Vivian's field notes

74 A processor that catches this can freeze the funds, including a sub's money.

Unverified

75 If any of this sounds familiar, set a cap in a calm hour, keep a stop that works at once, and wait before you raise either.

Vivian's field notes

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.